LVNA
EST 1958

VILLAGER

Volume 66 Edition 2 February 2023 Representing 1,614 Households

What's In This Issue

Tree Walk #6	1
LVNA Needs Help	3
In Case You Missed It	4
Village Center Meeting Recap	5
The Little Free Puzzle Library	6
The Story Behind the New Fencing at Fairwood Park	7
Scavenger Hunt	9

- Lakewood Park Tree Walk -

Tree #6: Aleppo Pine

It's been too many months since we did an entry from the SUFA (Sunnyvale Urban Forest Advocates) Lakewood Park Tree Walk. We covered five trees in 2022: the London Plane tree, the Italian Stone Pine, the Crape Myrtle, the Saucer Magnolia, and finally the Purple Leaf Plum. We begin 2023 with Tree #6, the Aleppo Pine.

Start today at the corner of Lakechime Drive and Silverlake Dr. Look south (towards the playground). On your side of the stone wall - a bit past the yellow "pedestrian crossing ahead" sign - you will see the tall, not-so-straight Aleppo Pine.



While not growing to the height of a redwood, the Aleppo Pine, Pinus halepensis, can grow 50-80 feet tall. Its trunk can get up to 4.5 feet in diameter. Also known as the Jerusalem pine, this species is believed to be the first holiday tree ever decorated. The trees tend not to grow straight up and, as they mature, they will shed their lower branches and develop a tall canopy with an open, cloud-like silhouette. The tall canopy provides ample shade, making the Aleppo Pine a wonderful overstory tree for arid climates.

The needles are slender, long (2.25-4.75 inches), and grow in pairs (rarely in threes). Their cones turn reddish-brown in color when they reach 24 months old and will slowly open after that (they will open faster if they are exposed to heat, such as from a wildfire). Aleppo Pines make good bonsai trees, their resin is used to flavor retsina (a Greek wine), and their pine nuts are used in desserts (prinjolata, which is a traditional dessert from Malta, and the Tunisian dessert assidat zgougou).

Fun fact, there are actually two Aleppo Pines along Silverlake Dr. Can you find the second one?

Want to learn more? Check out these links:

- https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Pinus_halepensis
- https://www.thespruce.com/growing-aleppo-pine-pinus-halepensis-3269312
- https://sites.redlands.edu/trees/species-accounts/aleppo-pine/

As a reminder, the tree walk maps can be found here (http://www.sunnyvaletrees.org/tree-walk-maps/), and the tree guides here (http://www.sunnyvaletrees.org/tree-guide/).

Courtesy to Sunnyvale Forest Advocates (SUFA) for allowing us to reproduce their website content in our Villager. For more information, see their website at http://www.sunnyvaletrees.org/

- LVNA Needs Help -

Are you passionate (or even just interested in) our neighborhood? Do you enjoy meeting new neighbors? Would you be willing to help build a tight-knit (Lakewood) Village for yourself, your friends, and the next generation who's currently growing up right outside your door or even in your own backyard?

Please join the LVNA board! There are five board positions: **President, 1st Vice President, 2nd Vice President, Treasurer, and Secretary**. The current board's positions end in March and a new board will begin. The board meets once per month to discuss ongoing activities, in addition to neighborhood general meetings and a few seasonal events each year. The level of commitment is up to each individual - these are all volunteer roles. It is a one-year term (March 2023 - March 2024). The only requirements are that you are 18+ years old, live in the neighborhood, and are able to serve the full 12 month term.

WANTED - VILLAGER EDITOR

Want to help, but not interested in a board position? We are looking for a new **Villager Editor**, a position open to anyone who is interested (no age requirement). The role consists of at least proof-reading the content and compiling it into a single document. Previous editors have also helped write content, design a new layout, take photos, and send the Villagers out to the subscribers each month.

Want to partner with a family member or friend? Great! Are you a high school student interested in writing or media design and trying to increase your community service hours or build a portfolio? This is your chance!

Any of these roles are a great opportunity to help actively drive change for our community and make a positive impact on our neighborhood. If interested, please email the board at board@lvnasv.org and let them know you're on board (yes, pun fully intended).

- In Case You Missed It -

The City sent out an update from the city manager on January 23. Topics included the Homestead Bike Lane Study, the Burglary Suppression Detail, Applications for Exhibitors for the Child Care Fair, Reason for the Season, and more. Find the full five-page report here: https://www.sunnyvale.ca.gov/home/showpublisheddocument/4257/638100588667434177

The Sunnyvale Public Library hosts a variety of events from bike safety information to storytimes to movies. Find a full list of library events here: https://www.library.sunnyvale.ca.gov/events/calendar-month-view

Sunnyvale has over 100 pieces of art displayed in public across the city. More details can be found here: https://www.sunnyvale.ca.gov/your-government/about/public-art There's an interactive map to locate the are here: https://explore.publicartarchive.org/sunnyvale-public-art/

Sunnyvale's Spring Activities Guide (for January - April) was released. The full brochure (including calls for hiring, internships, and public art jurors) can be found here: https://www.sunnyvale.ca.gov/your-government/governance/boards-and-commissions

Registration for summer camps through the City opened on February 6. For the full brochure of summer camps and aquatics programs, go here: https://issuu.com/sunnyvalelcs/docs/2023_camp_sunnyvale_splash_brochure_final

The City has openings on several boards and commissions, including the Bicycle and Pedestrian Advisory Commission, the Sustainability Commission, and the Heritage Preservation Commission. We need voices from our Lakewood neighborhood to serve these four-year terms! More information is here: https://www.sunnyvale.ca.gov/your-government/governance/boards-and-commissions

Sunnyvale Elementary School District Registration

Registration for Sunnyvale Elementary School District opened on February 1. Open enrollment runs Feb 1-14. If you want to request a transfer to a Program of Choice or another district school (not your neighborhood school), you must complete the open enrollment form in order to enter the district lottery. Some schools are offering tours now - check online for dates and times. More information can be found here: https://www.sesd.org/Page/241

The Programs of Choice are:

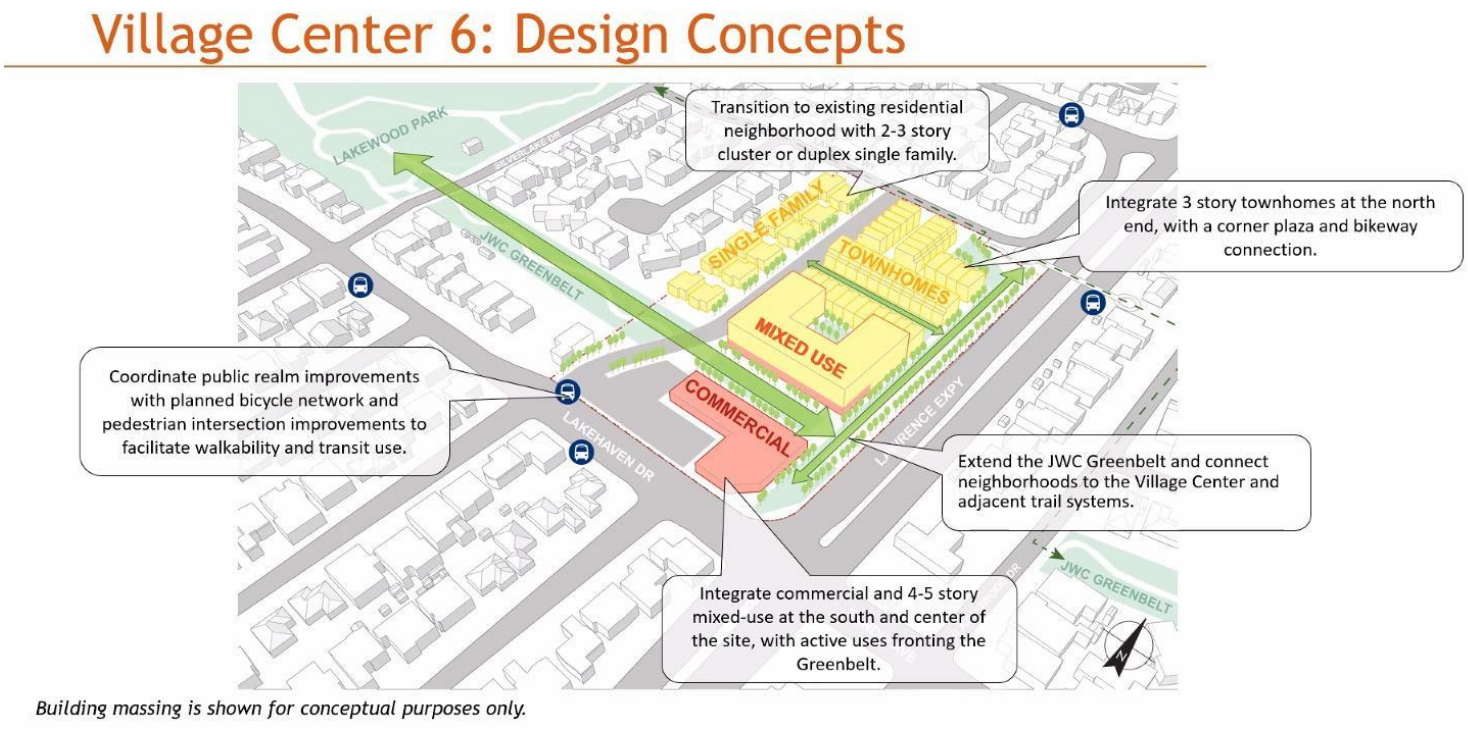
- Fairwood Elementary = Parent Participation
- Lakewood Elementary = Technology & Social Smarts
- San Miguel Elementary = Juntos Spanish-English Dual Immersion
- Bishop Elementary = Leadership
- Vargas Elementary = Science

More information and videos about Program of Choice can be found here: https://www.sesd.org/Page/242

- Village Center Meeting Recap -

There was a meeting hosted by Sunnyvale about the proposed Village Centers. There are 8 proposed village centers throughout Sunnyvale, one of which is in the Lakewood Shopping Center. The timeline isn't for quite a long time, anywhere from 5-20yrs. Nothing has been decided, but one potential way the Lakewood Village Center could be created is to have a mix of single family homes, townhouses, and multi-use buildings which consist of shops on the bottom level and apartments above. Many people were concerned about the current shop owners, the city answered by saying no lease will be terminated prematurely, and it depends on when the current plaza owners are willing to sell. Others were concerned with increased traffic and parking. Visit this link for more details, where you can also sign up to receive updates.

https://www.sunnyvale.ca.gov/business-and-development/projects-in-sunnyvale/long-range-planning-initiatives/village-center-master-plan



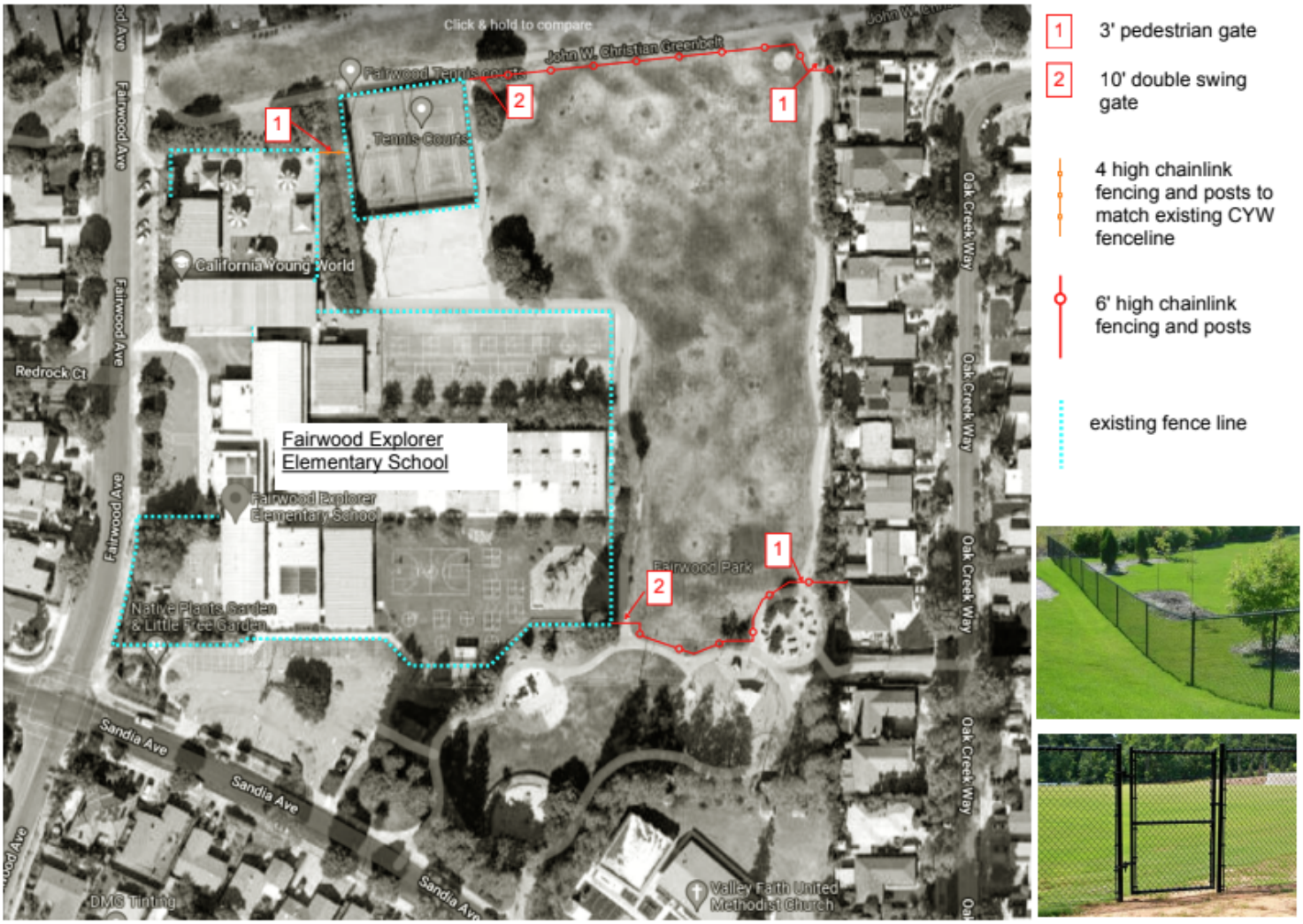
- The Little Free Puzzle Library -

A quick reminder that the Lakewood/Fairwood villages have their own Little Free Puzzle Library. Please come by to take a few puzzles or drop some off. As a gentle reminder, this is a resource for the entire community. Please take no more than 3 puzzles at a time. While it's not required to return the puzzles when you are done, returning them will help keep the Puzzle Library well stocked. For location information, please email vp1@lvnasv.org



The Story Behind the New Fencing at Fairwood Park

For anyone walking along the greenbelt near Fairwood Elementary (or anyone playing at Fairwood Park), you have likely noticed the new fencing. This fencing was installed by the Sunnyvale School District (SSD) in agreement with the City. The Villager chatted with Brandt Burns, Director of Facilities and Operations of the SSD to learn more.



Here are some highlights:

- The SSD property encompasses the entirety of the playfield and extends to the benches at the south side of the field. However, Fairwood students rarely used the space because of the safety and supervision issues associated with playing in the open space. Students could wander off or members of the public could wander onto the field when students were on it. By enclosing the field,

our students now have a safe, secure play area, providing them with more outdoor space in line with what already exists for students at the SSD elementary schools that are located south of Highway 101.

- The SSD held an open town hall at Fairwood Elementary on June 2, 2022. To raise awareness of the event, Fairwood Elementary sent out notification to all of their parents on May 31. SSD staff walked the neighborhood on May 27, placing flyers on nearby neighbors about the meeting. Unfortunately, the town hall was not well attended in spite of the outreach efforts.
- The decision to fence off the space was made by SSD in close collaboration with the City. The project costs were paid by SSD, not by the City. The decision to fence in the dirt paths on the east and west sides of the field was made due to costs and existing property lines.
- SSD has 10 campuses. Prior to this project, only the Fairwood Elementary and Lakewood Elementary campuses were not completely closed in. SSD and the City will continue to review opportunities to enclose the Lakewood Elementary campus in the coming years.
- The field will be closed to the public from 7:00am to 4:00pm on Monday-Friday during the school year. Signs on the fences provide contact information for SSD and the City Parks Department for additional questions.





- Neighborhood Scavenger Hunt -

Neighborhood Scavenger Hunt

Welcome to the monthly scavenger hunt! Send your name, address (to confirm that you live in the Lakewood/Fairwood neighborhood), and answers to the three questions to vp1@lvnasv.org by December 31, and we will announce the winner and the correct answers in the next newsletter. If there is a tie for the winner, we will randomly select one person as the winner. ***The winner will get to choose a $10 gift card from World Wrapps, Wal-Mart, or Giovanni's Pizzeria.***

1. Which of the following is NOT a position on the board of the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association?
    a. Treasurer
    b. 1st Vice President
    c. 2nd Treasurer
    d. President
2. True or False: Both Lakewood Park and Fairwood Park have tennis courts.
    a. True
    b. False
3. What is the name of the church that is on Lakewood Dr?
    a. Silicon Valley Methodist Church
    b. Silicon Valley Reformed Baptist Church
    c. Silicon Valley Church of Hope
    d. Silicon Valley Church of God

Answers from the January scavenger hunt:

1. *Which of these cities does NOT share a border with Sunnyvale? ANSWER: (b) San Jose*
2. *The November Villager included an article on the upcoming Sunnyvale Village Center plan. Which Village Center is the one that will be in the Lakewood Neighborhood? ANSWER: (c) Village Center 6*
3. *True/False: Torrance Ave and Sandia Ave run parallel to each other. ANSWER: (a) True*

LVNA CONTACTS

President	Lydia Fotiades	president@lvnasv.org
1st VP	Cortney Jansen	vp1@lvnasv.org
Treasurer	Linh Ly	treasurer@lvnasv.org
Secretary	Brad Dux	secretary@lvnasv.org

IMPORTANT NUMBERS

Emergency	911
Abandoned Vehicles	(408) 730-7150
Shopping Carts & Graffiti	(408) 730-7680
Animal Control	(408) 730-7178
Neighborhood Preservation	(408) 730-7610
Parks & Maintenance	(408) 730-7506
Public Safety - Info	(408) 730-7100
Public Safety - Non-Emergency	(408) 730-7180
City Jobs	(408) 730-4790
Sewer/Water/Utilities	(408) 730-4700
Street Lights/Sidewalks	(408) 730-7415
Street Trees/Parks	(408) 730-7505

January Meeting Recap

There was no meeting held in January.

Upcoming Events

February / March

Nothing Planned

Find us on Nextdoor!

If you have not already joined the LVNA group on Nextdoor then we encourage you to do so. Nextdoor allows separate settings for group posts so it's an excellent way to get curated Lakewood Village-relevant content while filtering out the rest. Board members post reminders about upcoming events and moderators ensure all activity in the group adheres to the group's rules (e.g., content relevant to Lakewood Village, no soliciting, etc.). Note that only Lakewood Village residents are permitted to join.

To learn more or to join, visit nextdoor.com/g/alya6yxap